

Snippets

Motorola Mobility is now a Lenovo company

Lenovo has acquired Motorola Mobility from Google. The deal was closed at US\$ 2.91 billion. Lenovo is now the third-largest smartphone maker in the world. Motorola will function as a wholly-owned subsidiary for Lenovo with its headquarters at Chicago. Liu Jun, Lenovo EVP and president of Lenovo's mobile business will serve as chairman for the newly-established Motorola management board and Rick Osterloh will continue to serve as president and COO of Motorola.

Tata group invests in Swiss solar firm, Flisom

Tata group has invested in a Swiss start-up solar company at a time when European companies are competing against each other to participate in the Indian solar energy market. Flisom is focused on developing copper indium gallium selenide solar cells, which are best suited for India's needs.

Samsung pulls back LED lighting business

Samsung's LED business will be put to halt outside South Korea, though this business showed huge potential four years ago. The company has not managed to find a place in the LED lighting industry globally—the market has been strongly dominated by companies like Philips and Osram, along with emerging Chinese manufacturers. According to Reuters, Samsung Electronics will still remain active in the LED industry through LED component business and will focus more on backlighting for displays of consumer products like televisions.

Infosys to expand Electronics City in Bengaluru

Infosys is planning to expand its Electronics City campus in Bengaluru to meet the medium-term need for higher capacity. Infosys owns a 6.07 hectare (15-acre) land bank at Electronics City, apart from its main 32.37 hectare (80-acre) campus. It now needs an approval from the state government to utilise this land.

mobile phones, laptops and other consumer electronics like flat-panel televisions, so that companies are forced to at least assemble the products in India. Government will gradually increase component duties to force manufacturers to shift their base to India.

Top officials have pointed out that the import of electronic items is second only to oil, which was at a gigantic amount of US\$ 40 billion in 2013-2014. They have even predicted that electronics imports will surpass oil imports by 2020.

The new rates will be part of the next budget. However, this increase would be graded as per the duty commitments made to countries in bi-lateral trade pacts. The incentive scheme for electronic units will provide a subsidy on capital investment up to 20 per cent, apart from reimbursing import duties and countervailing duties for such hardware setups. Sony, which has sales target of ₹ 120,000 million, does not have any factory in India and imports mostly from Thailand, taking advantage of the trade pact.

Wipro to focus on 3D printing

Wipro is focusing on developing its 3D printing business ever since Malthes Somasekarappa, head of Wipro's 3D printing unit, received an order for a 3D-printed skull for a patient's surgery.

Wipro has recently invested US\$ 1 million in a 3D printer. The company has been using it for manufacturing fuel nozzles of aeroplane engines and satellite antennae parts of hydraulic pumps. 3D printing plants have highly-automated systems that can manufacture units using only one metal piece.

Many global manufacturers such as Nike, General Electric, Siemens and Rolls Royce, have already adopted 3D printing. This industry has grown to US\$ 6 billion in the last three years. Many Indian manufacturing companies are also adopting this technology for better prototyping and small-time manufacturing.

Most of Wipro's clients of this business are from aerospace, healthcare and defence sectors. Hindustan Aeronautics

Limited is getting vane guides 3D-printed from Wipro. Vane guides are used in an engine's combustion chamber. A motorbike manufacturing company is also taking Wipro's help in 3D-printing some parts. Wipro has not leaked detailed information of its clients for 3D printing and their orders. According to sources, Wipro has partnered with General Electric for manufacturing fuel nozzles.

Wipro has purchased the 3D printer from EOS. According to EOS, India is the best country right now for the development of manufacturing industry. As much as 30 per cent of global design manufacturing is done by Indians.

Even though 3D printing technology is not yet popular among small-scale manufacturing companies, in some domains like defence, healthcare and aviation, companies like Wipro are coming up with next-generation technology for high-tech manufacturing. It is aiming to tap in this soon-to-be a billion-dollar industry.

Trina Solar to set-up solar PV module manufacturing hub in India

As a result of PM Modi's 'Make in India' initiative, China based solar photovoltaic module manufacturer, Trina Solar, has announced its plan to set-up solar PV module production facilities in India. CEO Zhiguo Zhu made the announcement at World Economic Forum, which recently took place in Delhi.

Chinese solar photovoltaic module manufacturers have been witnessing anti-dumping investigations from almost all leading solar power markets, from Australia to the USA. Recently, Indian government had announced its decision of not implementing anti-dumping duties on imported solar PV modules and instead, had planned to use domestic solar PV modules by setting-up major projects via government-owned companies.

In order to escape these anti-dumping duties, the company is eyeing to get at least 20 to 30 per cent of the total production from outside China.

Zhu said that, if Indian government would make regulations simpler and clearer, many more international companies would be willing to invest in the country.

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